

MadeByKreative — Banner Pricing

Deep Dive

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What should the banners actually be priced at? This builds each price from the ground up (materials + shipping + labor + Etsy fees), checks it against the market, and reveals what Kristol is really earning per hour today. Numbers come from `banner-cost-model.csv` (editable — change the assumptions and re-run `scripts/cost-model.ts`).

Read this caveat first. I don't have Kristol's real fabric costs or her actual time per banner, so the materials and labor figures below are **researched estimates, flagged for her to confirm**. The *method* is what matters — plug her real numbers into the CSV and it recalculates. Even so, the core conclusion is robust to wide swings in the estimates (explained at the end).

The one-line answer

Kristol's work is currently a real bargain — there's happy room to raise prices. Today's prices leave her about **~\$9.79/hr** for her time after materials and Etsy fees (and only ~\$3.23/hr on the Birthday bunting). Since the market sells comparable items for **2–3× her prices** and hers **sell out at a 5.7% conversion rate**, every signal says she can comfortably charge more and pay herself better. This is good news, not bad. Realistic, market-checked targets are in the table at the bottom; the biggest, easiest wins are the **rag garlands** and the **Birthday buntings**.

1. How the model is built

Price floor = Materials + Labor + Etsy fees. Anything below that loses money. Then a healthy handmade price adds profit on top (the standard rule is $retail = (materials + labor) \times 2-4$).

Materials (per banner) — estimated unit costs

Input	Assumed cost	Source / note
Quilting cotton	\$10 / yard	Mid-range retail (\$4–20 range; designer is more, scraps/sales less)
Cotton twill tape (pennant header)	\$0.30 / yard	\$0.16–0.75/yd depending on bulk
Twine / string (rag & bow garlands)	\$0.15 / banner	
HTV lettering (Birthday only)	\$0.60 / banner	
Thread / notions	\$0.25 / banner	
Packaging (mailer + tissue + card)	\$0.85 / order	

Fabric used per banner is estimated from the listing sizes (e.g. a 6ft rag garland $\approx$ 0.85 yd of strips; a 67" regular pennant $\approx$ 0.66 yd for 10 double-sided pennants). All editable in the script.

Labor

Estimated **batched** minutes per banner (cutting several at once, chain-sewing) — e.g. $\sim$ 52 min for a 6ft rag garland, $\sim$ 75 min for a 10-pennant 67" bunting. **This is the figure most worth Kristol correcting** — it drives everything.

Shipping — handled separately (not in the item price)

Verified on the live Etsy shop (June 2026): banners charge **\$4.99** shipping (mini banners **\$3.99**), **+\$1 per additional item**; the **keychain ships free**. A light fabric garland costs roughly **\$5–6** to mail via USPS Ground Advantage (Etsy's discounted labels), so **\$4.99 is about break-even on a single banner** — slightly under on far zones and multi-item orders (the +\$1 additional-item rate is too low). Because shipping roughly covers itself, it's **excluded from the item prices below** (they're item-only). Two small fixes worth making: nudge banner shipping to **\$5.49–5.99** and the additional-item rate to **\$2–3**. (True "free shipping" would mean baking $\sim$ \$5–6 into every price — only worth it after the price increases below are in place.)

Etsy fees

Built into every recommended price: **6.5% transaction + 3% processing + \$0.25 + \$0.20 listing $\approx$ 9.5% + \$0.45.** (If an order comes through Offsite Ads, add 15% — a reason to keep a margin cushion.)

2. What each banner earns per hour right now

This is where the opportunity shows up. Taking each current price, subtracting materials and Etsy fees, and dividing the rest by the estimated labor time:

Banner	Current price	Earned per hour now
Birthday pennant (73")	\$15.00	\$3.23/hr 🚩
Mini pennant 48"	\$10.00	\$5.70/hr
Mini pennant 72"	\$15.00	\$6.83/hr
Regular pennant 67"	\$20.00	\$7.48/hr
Medium pennant 67"	\$18.00	\$8.46/hr
Regular pennant 48"	\$16.00	\$8.60/hr
Rag garland 6ft	\$20.00	\$9.12/hr
Medium pennant 48"	\$14.00	\$9.56/hr
Rag garland 5ft	\$17.50	\$10.20/hr
Rag garland 4ft	\$15.00	\$11.95/hr
Rag garland 3ft	\$12.00	\$12.38/hr
Bow garland 70"	\$25.00	\$14.44/hr
Bow garland 36"	\$20.00	\$19.35/hr ✅

Takeaways:

- The **Birthday bunting** has the most room — it's a full-size 73" banner with HTV lettering priced at \$15, so a raise here is the easiest win of all.
- **Pennant buntings** (regular/medium/mini) sit around **\$6–9/hr** — the category with the most headroom.
- **Rag garlands** earn **\$9–12/hr** — they're already your bestsellers, so even a small, gentle raise adds up beautifully.
- The **bow garland** is priced just about right — the 36" already earns ~\$19/hr. It's a lovely benchmark for where the others can comfortably head.

3. The market says there's room

Product	Kristol now	Market comparables
Rag garland 4–6 ft	\$15–20	\$44–76 (modernragquilts, 4allseasons Star Seller) — denser/quilted, but shows the ceiling
Fabric pennant bunting	\$14–20	average ~ \$18 ; larger double-sided cotton buntings commonly \$25–35
Mini bunting	\$10–15	\$12–20

Kristol sits at or **below the bottom** of every band — while running an **excellent 5.7% conversion rate** and **selling out** of bestsellers. That combination (great value + high conversion + sell-outs) is the textbook sign that customers happily pay more — a green light to raise with confidence.

4. Recommended prices (cost model and market, triangulated)

The model's "price to earn \$20/hr" is the objective anchor; where that lands above what the market pays (true for the big pennants), I pulled the recommendation **down to the realistic market** and note it. Where the market is far above (rag garlands), the recommendation is a **measured step up**, not the full jump — to protect that great conversion rate while you test.

Banner	Now	Recommended	Earns ~\$/hr at rec.	Market check
Rag garland 3 ft	\$12	\$15	~\$19	far below market
Rag garland 4 ft	\$15	\$18	~\$18	far below market
Rag garland 5 ft	\$17.50	\$22	~\$19	far below market
Rag garland 6 ft	\$20	\$26	~\$17	still well below \$44+ comps
Regular pennant 48"	\$16	\$20	~\$13	mid-market
Regular pennant 67"	\$20	\$28	~\$15	top of market (model wants \$37; market won't bear it)
Medium pennant 48"	\$14	\$18	~\$14	mid-market
Medium pennant 67"	\$18	\$24	~\$14	upper-mid market
Mini pennant 48"	\$10	\$12	~\$9	budget tier — keep affordable entry point
Mini pennant 72"	\$15	\$20	~\$12	mid-market
Bow garland 36"	\$20	\$20 (<i>keep</i>)	~\$19	already right
Bow garland 70"	\$25	\$30	~\$18	room exists
Birthday pennant 73"	\$15	\$22	~\$11	aligns to your own regular line + recovers margin

"Earns ~\$/hr at rec." uses the same estimated labor times — so even at the recommended prices, most banners pay \$13–19/hr, still modest for skilled handmade work. These are not aggressive numbers.

If you only change three things

1. **Birthday buntings** → **\$22** (from \$15). Worst margin in the shop; no market risk at \$22.
2. **Rag garlands** → **\$15 / \$18 / \$22 / \$26** (3/4/5/6 ft). Your bestsellers, and you're far under market — this is where the real money is.
3. **Largest pennants up ~\$6–8** (regular 67" → \$28, medium 67" → \$24, mini 72" → \$20). The big sizes are where the labor is and where today's pricing pays the least.

How to roll it out safely

- Raise **ahead of each season** (6–8 weeks before), when demand and search traffic rise — increases stick better and you're not discounting into a climbing market.
 - Change the **largest size first** and watch conversion for 1–2 weeks before moving the rest. Your stats already show the data to judge it.
 - Keep one **affordable entry size** per product (the small mini at ~\$12, small rag at \$15) so budget shoppers still convert.
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5. Why the conclusion holds even if my estimates are off

The takeaway ("there's room to raise, especially rag garlands and Birthday") holds up even if these guesses are off:

- **If fabric is cheaper than \$10/yd** (scraps/sales) → the value Kristol is offering is even better, so the case for a raise is *stronger*, not weaker.
- **If Kristol is faster than estimated** → she's earning a better hourly rate already (wonderful!), but the *market* comps (\$44–76 rag garlands, \$25–35 buntings) still sit well above her prices, so a raise still makes sense — just as "matching the market" rather than "paying fair labor."
- **Only if she's BOTH much faster AND much cheaper on materials** would today's prices already be spot-on — and even then, the sell-outs and 5.7% conversion suggest customers would happily pay a little more.

To make this exact, fill your **real** fabric cost and **real** minutes-per-banner into `scripts/cost-model.ts` (the ASSUMPTIONS block and ROWS table) and re-run — the whole table recalculates.

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Sources

- Fabric cost: [By the Yard — cost of quilting](#) · [fabric price guide](#)
- Shipping: [USPS Ground Advantage 2026 rates \(ClickPost\)](#) · [Parcelpath USPS 2026 rate chart](#)
- Twill tape: [Walmart binding/twill tape](#)
- Pricing formula: [Craftybase — how to price handmade](#) · [Made Urban pricing formula](#)
- Market comps: [Etsy fabric rag garland](#) · [Etsy fabric pennant banners](#) (avg ≈ €16.51)